

Still Waters

3-Day Devotional

Scripture-shaped reflection through trusting God in uncertainty.

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How to Use This Devotional

This devotional is structured for six days of personal reading, reflection, and prayer. Each day follows the same rhythm: a timeless quote, a scripture passage, a reflection, a moment of stillness, action steps, and a closing prayer. Begin on any day of the week. The order within each day is intentional — let each element do its work before moving to the next.

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Psalm 23:1-2 - He makes me lie down in green pastures

Timeless Wisdom

*An ineffable but all-sufficient sacrifice had to be made
before God could righteously forgive His people.*

- Arthur W. Pink, The Sovereignty of God

Scripture Reading

Ps 23:1-2 (NASB)

The Lord, the Psalmist's Shepherd.

A Psalm of David.

The Lord is my shepherd,

I shall not want.

He makes me lie down in green pastures;

He leads me beside quiet waters.

Reflection

Psalm 23:1-2 opens with a scene marked by faithful response to God's word. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: He makes me lie down in green pastures. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. What the passage shows through makes, lie, down must be received before it is applied. That keeps the reading honest. worship and wisdom under the word of god. Psalm 23:1-2 stays

Still Before God

- Sit with Psalm 23:1-2 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of faithful response to God's word slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for concrete obedience that takes makes and down seriously rather than at a distance today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Psalm 23:1-2 calls for concrete obedience that takes makes and down seriously rather than at a distance today:

- Write one sentence naming how Psalm 23:1-2 presses on the scene of He makes me lie down in green pastures.
- Name one place where concrete obedience that takes makes and down seriously rather than at a distance should change the way you listen, speak, or act today.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Psalm 23:1-2. In this passage You bring faithful response to God's word into the open through He makes me lie down in green pastures. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Psalm 23:1-2 opens with a scene marked by faithful response to God's word. Guard our speech from haste, our work from

Week 1 · Day 2

Psalm 23:3-4 - He guides me in the paths of righteousness For His name's sake

Timeless Wisdom

Anxiety does not empty tomorrow of its sorrows, but only empties today of its strength.

- Charles H. Spurgeon, Metropolitan Tabernacle Pulpit

Scripture Reading

Ps 23:3-4 (NASB)

He restores my soul;

He guides me in the paths of righteousness

For His name's sake.

Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death,

I fear no evil, for You are with me;

Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me.

Reflection

Psalm 23:3-4 opens with a scene marked by truthfulness under pressure. The text brings costly obedience into view and refuses every attempt to make sacrifice feel decorative. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: He guides me in the paths of righteousness For

Still Before God

- Sit with Psalm 23:3-4 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of truthfulness under pressure slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for concrete obedience that takes guides and paths seriously rather than at a distance today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of confession, courage, or repentance before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Psalm 23:3-4 calls for concrete obedience that takes guides and paths seriously rather than at a distance today:

→ Name one costly act of obedience that Psalm 23:3-4 places before you today.

→ Accept one inconvenience without complaint as a small act of cross-shaped faithfulness.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Psalm 23:3-4. In this passage You bring truthfulness under pressure into the open through He guides me in the paths of righteousness For His name's sake. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near the crucified Christ, and do not let us soften suffering love into something easier than holy obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Psalm 23:3-4 opens with a scene marked by truthfulness under pressure. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from whatever would pull us away from obedient love instead of self-saving instinct. Help us

Psalm 23:5-6 - Surely goodness and lovingkindness will follow me all the days of my life

Timeless Wisdom

Faith and repentance are the two wings by which we fly to Christ.

- Thomas Watson, The Doctrine of Repentance

Scripture Reading

Ps 23:5-6 (NASB)

You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies;

You have anointed my head with oil;

My cup overflows.

Surely goodness and lovingkindness will follow me all the days of my life,

And I will dwell in the house of the Lord forever.

Reflection

Psalm 23:5-6 opens with a scene marked by new allegiance demanded by Christ's presence. The text does not ask the reader to admire the moment from a distance. The passage puts one clear scene in front of us: Surely goodness and lovingkindness will follow me all the days of my life. We should stay with that scene before we rush to a slogan. What the passage shows through surely, goodness, lovingkindness must be received before it is applied. That keeps the reading honest. watchful surrender before costly obedience. Psalm 23:5-6 stays concrete through The hearer prepare a table before me in — the specific language of surely, goodness, lovingkindness does the work before any principle is named. What we see in Psalm 23:5-6 shows how faith voices its inner state honestly rather than hiding it behind composed religious language. The point is not bare information. It presses into new allegiance instead of managed religious compatibility. We should not drift into generic encouragement detached from the scene. We should let the passage name the pressure point for the day. If the scene is shaped by Surely goodness and lovingkindness will follow me all the days of my life, then obedience today should answer that same pressure point. Where the text exposes fear, we should leave lesser loyalties behind where Christ's presence demands a new pattern of life. Where it honors devotion, we should practice grateful obedience within God's generous boundaries. Where it reveals God's worth clearly, we should pursue wholehearted response to Christ's disruptive nearness rather than delay. That keeps the day under the authority of Scripture. Strong exposition stays close to the text. It does not chase a clever slogan. It lets the details do their work on the conscience. That kind of reading slows us down. It teaches us to listen before we react. It also keeps prayer and application from drifting away from the passage. When the text warns, we should feel the warning. When the text comforts, we should receive the comfort. When the text humbles us, we should not dodge that weight. This is how devotion stays truthful, steady, and alive. The text rewards slow attention because its details are

Still Before God

- Sit with Psalm 23:5-6 for two quiet minutes. Read the scene of new allegiance demanded by Christ's presence slowly and let it settle before you move on.
- Where does this passage call for grateful obedience within God's generous boundaries today?
- Stay for one more minute and answer God with one honest sentence of trust, repentance, or gratitude before continuing.

Walk It Out

Because Psalm 23:5-6 calls for grateful obedience within God's generous boundaries today:

- Before your next decision, pause and ask how Psalm 23:5-6 should shape your response.
- Offer one concrete act of service that matches the patience or steadiness this passage commends.

Prayer

Father, thank You for speaking clearly in Psalm 23:5-6. In this passage You bring new allegiance demanded by Christ's presence into the open through Surely goodness and lovingkindness will follow me all the days of my life. Lord, keep us from reading these words as distant history only, and press them into our ordinary obedience today. Where we resist the truth highlighted in this reflection, bring repentance and renewed trust. Keep us near Your word, and do not let ordinary pressure turn us away from humble obedience. Holy Spirit, take what we have seen in the exposition and turn it into worship instead of mere information. Teach us to remember that Psalm 23:5-6 opens with a scene marked by new allegiance demanded by Christ's presence. Guard our speech from haste, our work from pride, and our choices from

Footnotes

1. Arthur W. Pink, The Sovereignty of God, (Grand Rapids: Baker Book House, 1918), Ch. 8.
2. Charles H. Spurgeon, Metropolitan Tabernacle Pulpit, (London: Passmore and Alabaster, 1875), Sermon No. 1248.
3. Thomas Watson, The Doctrine of Repentance, (Edinburgh: Banner of Truth Trust, 1668), Ch. 1.

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